

DISCOURSE OF THE SOLSTICE 2026

Word spoken before the earth, under the Two Row Wampum

TOME VIII — THE SOLSTICE DISCOURSE

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EIGHTH PART

The solstice discourse

What the earth hears when I speak — June 21, 2026, Longhouse, Turtle Island

On June 21, 2026, I spoke. Not before a tribunal. Not before a camera. Not to be broadcast. I spoke before the earth, under the solstice sun, at the Longhouse, on Turtle Island. I spoke as one speaks when one knows that speech is an act, not a performance. I spoke as one speaks when one knows that those who listen are not only the visible living, but also the ancestors, the descendants, the stones, the trees, the river.

What follows is the discourse I pronounced that day. It is complete, unchanged. It is the central pillar of this story. It is the moment when breath became word, when choice became act, when silence found its voice.

I begin here today by thanking the Longhouse for receiving me as well as allowing me to express myself, to have listened to me, to have heard me.

I thank the life-givers for their welcome as well as their help, their support.

Welcome and good day to all!

My name is Nabek, son of Carole, grandson of Isabelle, great-grandson of [...]

I do not speak from neutrality. I speak from an unceded land. I speak from Turtle Island on the Tiohtià:ke territory.

You may call it Montreal, in Quebec? in Canada? but these names are labels placed by people who came, who took. Proclamation! "this is ours." We rename everything... Doctrine inked and perpetuated since a pope signed: Where we set foot!!! The doctrine of discovery. The key element of property. That through which everything genocidal passes. We all know the song...

I am a descendant of French colonists. My blood comes from those who arrived on ships, although in my lineage there was, in a distant way, certain links having engendered, I do not claim in any way, nor

do I claim, any belonging in any way to identify myself coming from the institution that imposed itself on these lands.

Nine years ago, I left the ship.

Not the ship of the sea, but the ship of the system. The ship of the colony. The ship of the invisible colonist who lives in each of us, who speaks through our laws, who thinks through our schools, who judges through our courts.

I left. I de-registered. I de-identified. I de-authorized myself.

And today, on this solstice day, I speak not as a citizen, not as a subject, not as a resident, but as a free man standing on free land, under the Wampum of Two Rows, where two canoes navigate the same river without ever interfering with each other.

I speak of what I have seen. I speak of what I have understood. I speak of what I refuse.

I refuse the doctrine of discovery. I refuse the fiction of property. I refuse the registration of the living. I refuse the numbering of souls. I refuse the categorization of beings. I refuse the hierarchy of races. I refuse the monopoly of violence. I refuse the legitimacy of the usurper.

I refuse to be a number. I refuse to be a category. I refuse to be a subject. I refuse to be a citizen of a state that has no legitimacy on this land. I refuse to pledge allegiance to a flag that has no meaning for the earth. I refuse to pay tribute to a crown that has no roots in this soil.

I am not a Canadian. I am not a Quebecer. I am not a Frenchman. I am Nabek. Son of Carole. Grandson of Isabelle. Great-grandson of [...]. And before that, I am a child of the earth. A child of the sun. A child of the river. A child of the wind.

And I speak to you today not to convince you, not to convert you, not to recruit you. I speak to you because speech is an act. Because to speak is to exist. Because to remain silent is to consent. And I do not consent.

I do not consent to the genocide that continues. I do not consent to the ecocide that accelerates. I do not consent to the epistemicide that erases. I do not consent to the linguicide that silences. I do not consent to the culturicide that standardizes.

I do not consent to the theft of land. I do not consent to the poisoning of water. I do not consent to the cutting of forests. I do not consent to the extinction of species. I do not consent to the enslavement of peoples.

And I do not consent to my own enslavement. To my own domestication. To my own colonization. To my own registration. To my own categorization.

I am not a social security number. I am not a health insurance number. I am not a driver's license number. I am not a passport number. I am not a tax number. I am not a file number. I am not a case number.

I am a breath. I am a heartbeat. I am a thought. I am a word. I am an act. I am a choice. I am a responsibility.

And I choose to be free.

Free from the colony. Free from the system. Free from the ship. Free from the invisible colonist who whispers in my ear that I need permission to exist, that I need authorization to speak, that I need legitimacy to act.

I need none of these things. I need only the earth beneath my feet, the sun above my head, the river at my side, and the Wampum in my heart.

The Wampum of Two Rows. Two canoes. One river. Two paths. One destination: peace. One method: respect. One condition: non-interference.

I do not interfere in your canoe. You do not interfere in mine. We navigate side by side. We share the river. We share the sun. We share the rain. We share the wind. But we do not share our sovereignty. We do not share our autonomy. We do not share our identity.

And that is the difference between the Wampum and the treaty. The treaty divides. The Wampum unites. The treaty takes. The Wampum gives. The treaty imposes. The Wampum invites. The treaty colonizes. The Wampum liberates.

I speak today under the Wampum. Not under the treaty. I speak as a free man to free men. As a living being to living beings. As a child of the earth to children of the earth.

And I say to you: leave the ship.

Not with violence. Not with hatred. Not with anger. But with clarity. With determination. With courage. With love.

Leave the ship of the colony. Leave the ship of the system. Leave the ship of the invisible colonist. Leave the ship of registration. Leave the ship of categorization. Leave the ship of authorization. Leave the ship of legitimacy.

And come to the earth.

Come to the land. Come to the soil. Come to the forest. Come to the river. Come to the mountain. Come to the prairie. Come to the wetland. Come to the tundra. Come to the desert. Come to the island. Come to the peninsula. Come to the archipelago.

Come where the earth speaks. Where the wind teaches. Where the rain cleanses. Where the sun illuminates. Where the moon guides. Where the stars remember.

Come and listen. Come and learn. Come and understand. Come and act.

Not tomorrow. Not next year. Not when the conditions are right. Not when you have enough money. Not when you have enough time. Not when you have enough courage.

Now.

Because now is the only time that exists. Because now is the only time that matters. Because now is the only time when choice is possible.

Yesterday is memory. Tomorrow is projection. Only now is real. Only now is present. Only now is alive.

And in this now, on this solstice day, under this sun, on this land, I choose freedom. I choose the earth. I choose the Wampum. I choose the Two Rows. I choose the canoe. I choose the river. I choose the breath. I choose the word. I choose the act.

I choose to be Nabek. Son of Carole. Grandson of Isabelle. Great-grandson of [...]. Child of the earth. Child of the sun. Child of the river. Child of the wind.

And I invite you to choose too.

Not my choice. Your choice. Not my path. Your path. Not my canoe. Your canoe. But on the same river. Under the same sun. With the same respect. With the same peace. With the same love.

This is the solstice discourse. This is what the earth heard when I spoke. This is what the ancestors heard. This is what the descendants will hear. This is what the stones heard. This is what the trees heard. This is what the river heard.

And now, it is what you hear.

What will you do with what you hear?

Will you forget? Will you ignore? Will you dismiss? Will you ridicule? Will you fear?

Or will you remember? Will you listen? Will you understand? Will you respect? Will you act?

The choice is yours. The time is now. The place is here. The earth is waiting.

Nabek Off the Ship — Turtle Island — Year 410 of the treaty of 1616